

Supplementary material for the Poster: The role of maternal age on stillbirth: a multi-country analysis of more than 180 million births

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1. Funding information

The Vulnerable Newborn-Stillbirth Collaboration was funded by the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation.

Project: Accelerating stillbirth reduction through big data analysis to inform risk and better measurement [INV-065760].

2. The Vulnerable Newborn-Stillbirths Collaborative Group

By setting, arranged in alphabetical order

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3. Ethics approval of institutional review boards

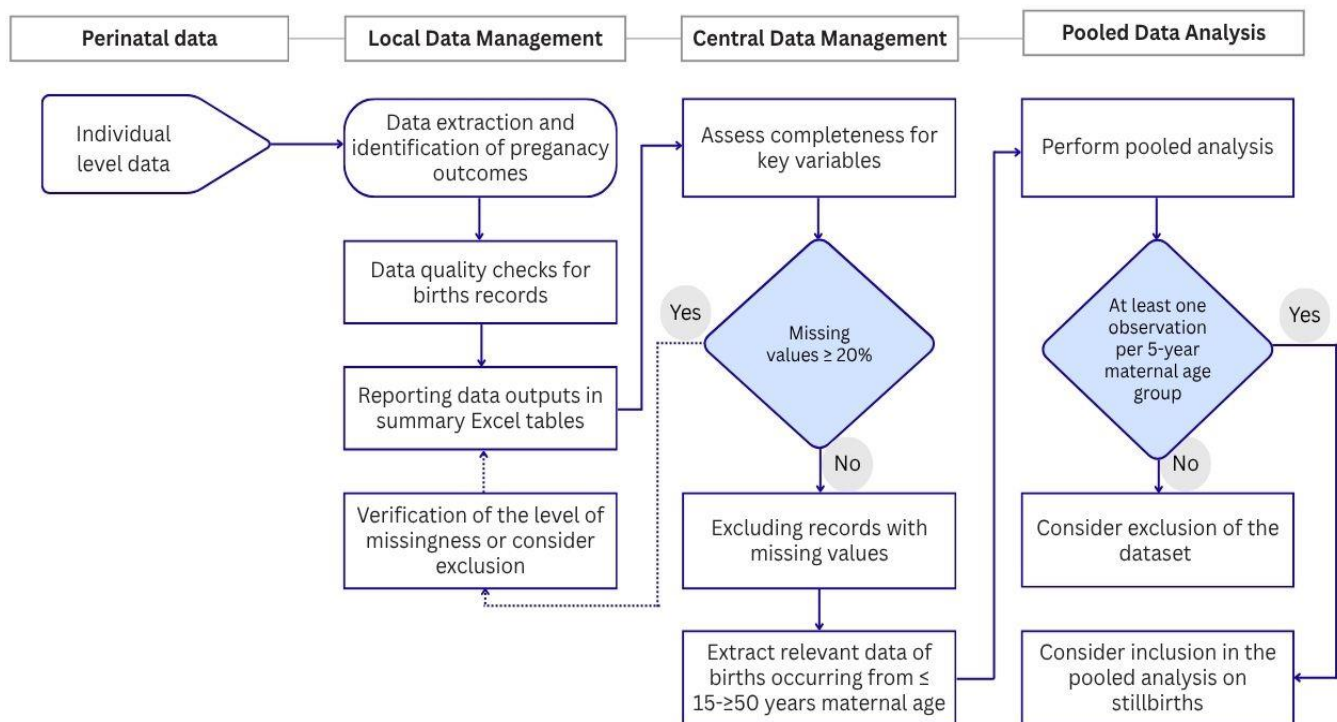
#	Site	Research Ethics Committee	Reference	Date
1	LSHTM - Overall VN-SB research project	London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine	31214	19 Jul 2024
2	ALERT_SN	National d'Ethique pour la Recherche en Santé, Cotonou, Bénin	068/MS/DRFMT/CNERS/SA	20 Jul 2020
		College of Medicine Research and Ethics Committee (COMREC), Malawi	P.04/20/3038	20 Jul 2020
		National Institute of Medical Research Tanzania, Tanzania	NIMR/HQ/R.8a/Vol.IX/3493	04 Aug 2020
		Makerere University School of Public Health, Higher Degrees, Research and Ethics Committee, Uganda	HDREC 808	9 Dec 2020
3	Argentina_N	Not required for public data		
4	Australia_N	Australian Institute of Health and Welfare Ethics Committee	EO2018/2/451	4 th May 2021
5	Belgium_N	The Security Information Committee (SCI) in June 2020 and January 2021 in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation	CSI/CSST/22/046	June 2020 and January 2021
6	Botswana_SN	Health Research and Development Committee, Botswana Ministry of Health & Wellness, Gaborone, Botswana	HPDME 13/18/1	27 Jun 2014

#	Site	Research Ethics Committee	Reference	Date
		Harvard Longwood Campus IRB, Office of Regulatory Affairs and Research Compliance, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health, Boston, MA, USA	IRB14-1352	12 May 2014
7	Brazil_N	Not required		
8	Cambodia_SN	Institut Pasteur and Ethics Committees of Cambodia	IRB/2016/08/03 and Cambodia (108 NEHCR)	03/08/2016
9	Canada_SN	UBC C&W Research Ethics Board	H21-00653	5 th January 2026
10	Chile_N	Not required for public data		
11	China_SN	Xinhua Hospital Affiliated to the Shanghai Jiao Tong University School of Medicine	XHEC-C-2015-006	20 Feb 2015
12	Denmark_N	Danish Data Protection Agency	2022-0367531	11 Dec 2024
13	England & Wales_N	Not required Data held by MBRRACE-UK (Mothers and Babies: Reducing Risk through Audits and Confidential Enquiries across the UK) were collected in England and Wales without consent with approval of the secretary of state for health and social care under section 251 of the NHS Act 2006 (15/CAG/0119). The legal basis for this activity is Article 6 (1)(e) and Article 9 (2)(i) under the General Data Protection Regulation.		
14	Estonia_N	National Institute for Health Development	7-8/387-1	14 Oct 2022
15	Ethiopia_SN1	Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia, Ministry of Education	8/152/324/25	29 Aug 2025
16	Ethiopia_SN2	ENAT study is approved by the Institutional Review Boards of Addis Continental Institute of Public Health and Mass General Brigham	001-A1-2019 and 2018P002479	
17	Finland_N	Not required for register-based research		
18	Ghana_SN	Ghana Health Service ERC; Kintampo Health Research Centre Institutional Ethics Committee	019/09/20 KHRCIEC/2020-17	
19	India_SN1	Indian Institute of Public Health- Bengaluru. Public Health Foundation of India	IIPHBLR/IEC/291/2025	08/04/2025
20	Iran_SN	National ethics committee of the National Institute for Medical Research Development	IR.NIMAD.REC.1394.013	20 June 2015
21	Japan_N	The Ethical Committee of the National Center for Child Health and Development	Protocol number 2023-093	26 Sep 2023
22	Kenya_SN	KEMRI Scientific and Ethics Review Unit Liverpool School of Tropical Medicine Ethics Committee	KEMRI/SERU/4166 23-020	

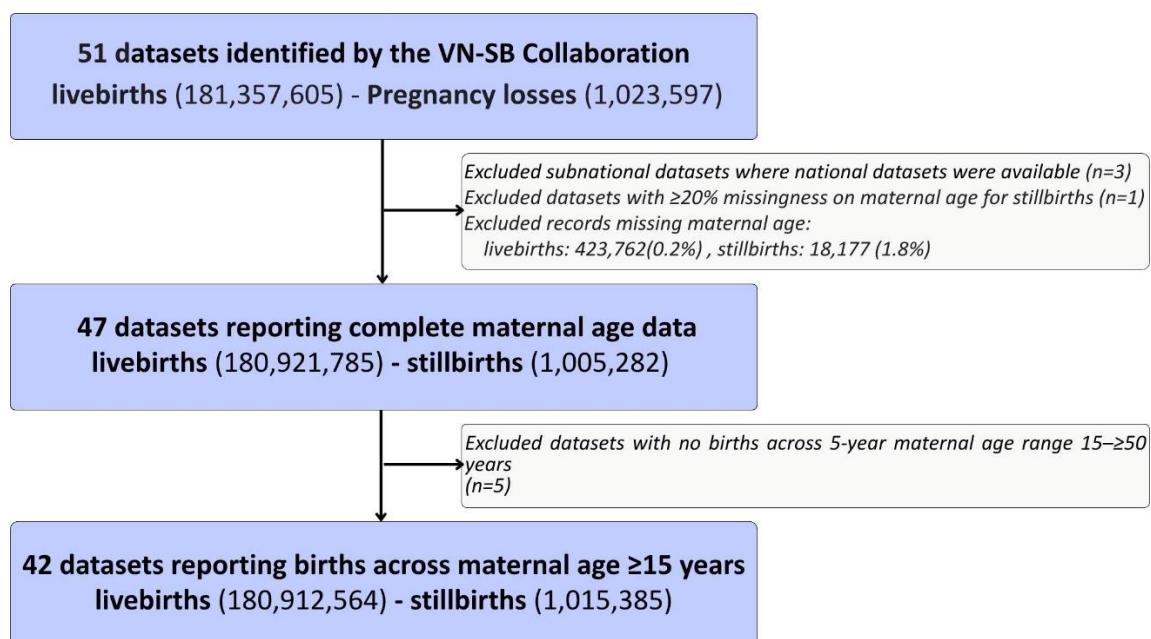
#	Site	Research Ethics Committee	Reference	Date
		Jaramogi Oginga Odinga Teaching and Referral Hospital (JOOTRH) Institutional Scientific Ethics Review Committee ISERC	ISERC/JOOTRH/549/2024	
23	Lebanon_N	American University of Beirut	PED.KY.01	15 Aug 2025
24	Madagascar_SN	Institut Pasteur in Paris and Ethics Committee in Madagascar	IRB/2016/08/03 and Madagascar (068-MSANP/CE and No119-MSANP/CERBM)	03/08/2026
25	Mexico_N	Juarez Hospital of Mexico	HJM 078/24-I	1 Jan 2025
26	Nepal_SN2	Ethical Review group of Nepal Health Research Council	2017-1643	16/03/2027
27	Nepal_SN3	Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health Institute of Medicine, Tribhuvan University	00001735 217(6-11-E)	28 May 2009 March 2009
28	Netherlands_N	The executive board of the Perined registry approved the use of registry data for this study. Individual patient consent was not required, as data were used in accordance with Perined regulations for scientific research. Pregnant individuals provide informed consent for research use through an opt-out process, as described in the 'Pregnant' leaflet provided upon entry into perinatal care.		
29	Norway_N	The Regional Committee for Medical and Health Research Ethics in South/East Norway.	(#2014/404)	
30	Papua New Guinea_SN	PNG Institute of Medical Research Institutional Review Board Papua New Guinea Medical Research Advisory Committee	IRB.1608 MRAC.16.24	April 2016 4 Oct 2016
31	Pakistan_SN1	The Aga Khan University ERC Pakistan National Institutes of Health—Health Research Institute, National Bioethics Committee:	No. 2023-9100-26333; 4-87/NBCR-1023/23/973	
32	PRECISE_SN	King's College London, Aga Khan University Hospital, The Gambia Government/The Medical Research Council, The Gambia Joint Committee and the Mozambique Ministry of Health, National Bioethics Committee for Health	HR-17/18-7855, 2018/REC-74, SCC 1619, and 545/CNBS/18	
33	Qatar_N	Medical Research Center, Hamad Medical Corporation	MRC-01-21-277	25th April 2021
34	Scotland_N	Not requiredData Protection, Public Health Scotland	SLIPBD DPIA DP22230174v6	1 May 2026
35	Slovenia_N	Not required for register-based research. De-identified data from the National Perinatal Information System of		

#	Site	Research Ethics Committee	Reference	Date
		Slovenia (NPIS). Data collection for the NPIS is mandated by law, and registration is compulsory for all maternity hospitals in our country.		
36	Sri Lanka_SN	Ethics Review Committee of the Faculty of Medicine, University of Colombo	Reference number EC-18-128	
37	Sweden_N	Regional Ethics Review Board in Umeå, Department for Other Research.	2018/99-31	24/04/2018
38	Tanzania_SN1	Medical Research Coordinating Committee (MRCC), housed by National Institute for Medical Research, Tanzania	NIMR/HQ/R.8a/Vol. IX/1717	6 May 2014
39	Tanzania_SN2	Medical Research Coordinating Committee (MRCC), housed by National Institute for Medical Research, Tanzania	NIMR/HQ/R.8a/Vol.IX/688	18 April 2008
40	Thailand_SMRU_SN	University of Oxford	OXTREC: 28-09	12-07-2024
41	USA_N	Not required for public data		
42	Uruguay_N	Not required for public data		
43	Zambia_SN2	<i>Boston University Institutional Review Board (FWA# 00008404) and the University of Zambia Research Ethics Committee (FWA# 00001131)</i>	BU-IRB: H-29647; UNZA IRB: 016-08-10	27 Sep 2021 (most recent approval); 17 Oct 2015 (final approval)

4. Data management



5. Data input



6. Number and percentage of missing maternal age and gestational age across the datasets

	Study	Livebirths					Stillbirths				
		Total (N)	Missing maternal age		Missing gestational age		Total (N)	Missing maternal age		Missing gestational age	
			(N)	(%)	(N)	(%)		(N)	(%)	(N)	(%)
1	ALERT_SN	134,114	117	0.1	2,473	1.8	5,133	2	0.0	248	4.8
2	Argentina_N	10,059,201	138,747	1.4	169,281	1.7	69,746	5,954	8.5	2,140	3.1
3	Argentina_SN	5,702	83	1.5	0	0.0	71	1	1.4	0	0.0
4	Australia_N	6,868,268	975	0.0	5,223	0.1	38,223	259	0.7	2,936	7.7
5	Belgium_N	503,008	0	0.0	723	0.1	2,399	0	0.0	27	1.1
6	Botswana_SN	314,814	184	0.1	8,665	2.8	7,977	11	0.1	413	5.2
7	Brazil_N	25,059,328	289	0.0	379,037	1.5	229,607	11,131	4.9	4,283	1.9
8	Brazil_SN	4,275	1	0.0	0	0.0	51	0	0.0	9	17.7
9	Cambodia_SN	810	0	0.0	8	1.0	9	0	0.0	0	0.0
10	Canada_SN	298,079	37	0.0	0	0.0	1,044	3	0.3	0	0.0
11	Chile_N	4,809,612	0	0.0	0	0.0	19,572	0	0.0	0	0.0
12	China_SN	74,183	88	0.1	2,258	3.0	949	5	0.5	109	11.5
13	Denmark_N	1,429,399	4,746	0.3	21,679	1.5	5,718	206	3.6	151	2.6
14	England & Wales_N	7,201,551	236,164	3.3	259,096	3.6	31,334	54	0.2	55	0.2
15	Estonia_N	82,322	905	1.1	16	0.0	251	12	4.8	1	0.4
16	Ethiopia_SN1	20,274	5	0.0	3,506	17.3	764	0	0.0	145	19.0
17	Ethiopia_SN2	2,114	0	0.0	12	0.6	54	0	0.0	1	1.9
18	Finland_N	1,312,102	0	0.0	3,624	0.3	4,076	1	0.0	278	6.8
19	Ghana_SN	1,797	0	0.0	0	0.0	40	0	0.0	0	0.0
20	India_SN1	3,348	0	0.0	1	0.0	24	0	0.0	0	0.0

	Study	Livebirths					Stillbirths				
		Total (N)	Missing maternal age		Missing gestational age		Total (N)	Missing maternal age		Missing gestational age	
			(N)	(%)	(N)	(%)		(N)	(%)	(N)	(%)
21	India_SN2	4,365	0	0.0	0	0.0	40	0	0.0	0	0.0
22	India_SN3	1,172	0	0.0	0	0.0	15	0	0.0	0	0.0
23	India_SN4	1,043	10	1.0	0	0.0	25	1	4.0	0	0.0
24	Iran_SN	24,087	1,734	7.2	0	0.0	61	6	9.8	0	0.0
25	Japan_N	22,151,382	161	0.0	264,461	1.2	73,938	10	0.0	49	0.1
26	Kenya_SN	1,758	2	0.1	0	0.0	40	0	0.0	0	0.0
27	Lebanon_N	333,796	25,417	7.6	15,928	4.8	2,215	83	3.8	499	22.5
28	Madagascar_SN	2,875	1	0.0	244	8.5	48	0	0.0	35	72.9
29	Mexico_N	1,520,611	0	0.0	0	0.0	14,285	97	0.7	83	0.6
30	Mexico_SN	1,416	0	0.0	0	0.0	17	0	0.0	0	0.0
31	Nepal_SN1	1,580	0	0.0	0	0.0	31	0	0.0	0	0.0
32	Nepal_SN2	231,177	0	0.0	15,595	6.8	3,578	0	0.0	544	15.2
33	Nepal_SN3	31,172	8	0.0	29	0.1	1,304	1	0.1	352	27.0
34	Netherlands_N	2,032,821	3,761	0.2	10,964	0.5	6,426	3	0.1	68	1.1
35	Norway_N	1,281,191	0	0.0	0	0.0	5,071	0	0.0	0	0.0
36	Papu New Guinea_SN	4,297	31	0.7	41	1.0	105	2	1.9	0	0.0
37	Pakistan_SN1	3,244	1	0.0	0	0.0	93	0	0.0	0	0.0
38	PRECISE_SN	5,540	1	0.0	96	1.7	45	0	0.0	2	4.4
39	Qatar_N	95,892	83	0.1	1,202	1.3	556	1	0.2	4	0.7
40	Scotland_N	1,290,000	2,153	0.2	0	0.0	6,584	247	3.8	0	0.0
41	Senegal_SN	749	0	0.0	59	7.9	9	9	100.0	9	100.0
42	Slovenia_N	191,945	0	0.0	3	0.0	577	0	0.0	0	0.0
43	Sri Lanka_SN	13,642	11	0.1	23	0.2	130	0	0.0	1	0.8
44	Sweden_N	2,005,457	364	0.0	812	0.0	7,169	0	0.0	23	0.3
45	Tanzania_SN1	426	5	1.2	1	0.2	15	0	0.0	3	20.0
46	Tanzania_SN2	915	1	0.1	4	0.4	32	0	0.0	0	0.0
47	Thailand_SMRU_SN	38,751	3	0.0	7	0.0	528	0	0.0	0	0.0
48	USA_N	91,362,788	6,634	0.0	324,634	0.4	480,650	65	0.0	53,221	11.1
49	Uruguay_N	501,524	770	0.2	11	0.0	2,132	3	0.1	0	0.0
50	Zambia_SN1	1,386	6	0.4	0	0.0	47	0	0.0	0	0.0
51	Zambia_SN2	36,302	264	0.7	5,127	14.1	789	10	1.3	223	28.3
	Total	180,912,255	423,662	0.2	1,494,784	0.8	1,005,125	18,166	1.8	65,894	6.4

7. Definitions

Definitions	
Livebirth	Is the complete expulsion or extraction from a woman of a fetus, irrespective of the duration of the pregnancy, which, after such separation, shows signs of life
Gestational age	The duration of gestation measured from the first day of the last menstrual period (LMP). Gestational age will be analysed in days where possible. Gestational age measured by LMP, early pregnancy ultrasound or best obstetric estimate (BEO) will be included
Stillbirth	Refers to the delivery or birth of a baby following fetal death at 154 days (22 ⁺⁰ complete weeks) or more of gestation. It is divided as: Early gestation between 154 and 195 days of gestation (22 ⁺⁰ –27 ⁺⁶ weeks) and Late gestation at 196 or more days gestation (≥28 ⁺⁰ weeks).
Calculated variables	
Total births	The sum of livebirths and stillbirths
Proportion of births	Number of births / total births
Indicators	
Stillbirth rate	Number of stillbirths/total births (stillbirths + livebirths) per 1000

8. Total births by dataset included in the analysis

Region	Study	Total births
High income countries (HICs)		
	Australia_N	6,905,257
	Belgium_N	505,407
	Canada_SN	299,083
	Chile_N	4,829,184
	Denmark_N	1,430,165
	England & Wales_N	6,996,667
	Estonia_N	81,656
	Finland_N	1,316,177
	Japan_N	22,225,149
	Netherlands_N	2,035,483
	Norway_N	1,286,262
	Qatar_N	96,364
	Scotland_N	1,294,184
	Slovenia_N	192,522
	Sweden_N	2,012,262
	USA_N	91,836,739
	Uruguay_N	502,883
Low-middle income countries (LMICs)		
	ALERT_SN	139,128

Ethiopia_SN1	21,033
Ethiopia_SN2	2,168
Madagascar_SN	2,922
Precise_SN	5,584
Tanzania_SN1	436
Tanzania_SN2	946
Cambodia_SN	819
Ghana_SN	1,837
India_SN1	3,372
Kenya_SN	1,796
Nepal_SN2	234,755
Nepal_SN3	32,467
PNG_SN	4,369
Pakistan_SN1	3,336
Sri Lanka_SN	13,761
Zambia_SN2	36,817
Argentina_N	9,984,246
Botswana_SN	322,596
Brazil_N	25,277,515
China_SN	75,039
Iran_SN	22,408
Lebanon_N	310,511
Mexico_N	1,534,799
Thailand_SMRU_SN	39,276

9. Births distribution by maternal age across the regions

Region	Total births	<15 years		15-19 years		20-24 years		25-29 years		30-34 years		35-39 years		40-43 years		≥45 years	
		N	(%)	N	(%)	N	(%)	N	(%)	N	(%)	N	(%)	N	(%)	N	(%)
HICs	143,845,444	113,025	0.1	8,830,926	6.1	27,335,006	19.0	40,405,058	28.1	41,107,184	28.6	21,179,475	14.7	4,528,972	3.2	345,798	0.2
LMICs	38,071,936	224,229	0.6	5,314,536	14.0	9,419,223	24.7	9,242,535	24.3	7,881,093	20.7	4,680,221	12.3	1,226,502	3.2	83,597	0.2

10. Stillbirth rate by maternal age across the regions

Region	<15 years		15-19 years		20-24 years		25-29 years		30-34 years		35-39 years		40-43 years		≥45 years	
	Stillbirths	SBR (95% CI)	Stillbirths	SBR (95% CI)	Stillbirths	SBR (95% CI)	Stillbirths	SBR (95% CI)	Stillbirths	SBR (95% CI)	Stillbirths	SBR (95% CI)	Stillbirths	SBR (95% CI)	Stillbirths	SBR (95% CI)
HICs	1,117	9.88 (9.31-10.48)	52,153	5.91 (5.86-5.96)	132,749	4.86 (4.83-4.88)	171,916	4.25 (4.23-4.27)	173,135	4.21 (4.19-4.23)	114,496	5.41 (5.37-5.44)	35,880	7.92 (7.84-8.00)	3,410	9.86 (9.53-10.20)
LMICs	2,705	12.06 (11.61-12.53)	47,264	8.89 (8.81-8.97)	74,647	7.92 (7.87-7.98)	69,464	7.52 (7.46-7.57)	61,330	7.78 (7.72-7.84)	45,422	9.71 (9.62-9.79)	17,476	14.25 (14.04-14.46)	1,961	23.46 (22.43-24.52)

11. Stillbirth rate ratio by maternal age across the regions

Region	<15 years	15-19 years	Overall ≤19 years	20-24 years	25-29 years	30-34 years	35-39 years	40-43 years	≥45 years	Overall ≥40 years
	RR (95% CI)	RR (95% CI)	RR (95% CI)	RR (95% CI)	RR (95% CI)	RR (95% CI)	RR (95% CI)	RR (95% CI)	RR (95% CI)	RR (95% CI)
HICs	2.32 (2.19-2.46)	1.39 (1.37-1.40)	1.40 (1.39-1.41)	1.14 (1.13-1.15)	Reference group	0.99 (0.98-1.00)	1.27 (1.26-1.28)	1.86 (1.84-1.88)	2.32 (2.24-2.40)	1.89 (1.87-1.92)
LMICs	1.61 (1.54-1.67)	1.18 (1.17-1.20)	1.20 (1.19-1.21)	1.05 (1.04-1.07)		1.04 (1.02-1.05)	1.29 (1.28-1.31)	1.90 (1.86-1.93)	3.12 (2.99-3.26)	1.97 (1.94-2.01)

12. Population attributable fraction (PAF) for stillbirth by maternal age across the regions- 25-29 years as reference group

a) For Adolescents ≤19 years

Region	Total births	<15 years			15-19 years			Overall ≤19 years		
		Birth (%)	RR (95% CI)	PAF% (95% CI)	Birth (%)	RR (95% CI)	PAF% (95% CI)	Birth (%)	RR (95% CI)	PAF% (95% CI)
HICs	143,845,444	0.08	2.32 (2.19-2.46)	0.10 (0.09-0.11)	6.14	1.39 (1.37-1.40)	2.33 (2.25-2.41)	6.22	1.40 (1.39-1.41)	2.43 (2.35-2.51)
LMICs	38,071,936	0.59	1.61 (1.54-1.67)	0.36 (0.32-0.39)	13.96	1.18 (1.17-1.20)	2.49 (2.31-2.68)	14.55	1.20 (1.19-1.21)	2.83 (2.64-3.02)

b) For mothers aged 20-39 years

Region	Total births	20-24 years			25-29 years	30-34 years			35-39 years		
		Birth (%)	RR (95% CI)	PAF% (95% CI)	Reference group	Birth (%)	RR (95% CI)	PAF% (95% CI)	Birth (%)	RR (95% CI)	PAF% (95% CI)
HICs	143,845,444	19.00	1.14 (1.13-1.15)	2.62 (2.47-2.76)		28.58	0.99 (0.98-1.00)	-0.29 (-0.48--0.10)	14.72	1.27 (1.26-1.28)	3.83 (3.70-3.96)
LMICs	38,071,936	24.74	1.05 (1.04-1.07)	1.33 (1.07-1.59)		20.70	1.04 (1.02-1.05)	0.73 (0.50-0.96)	12.29	1.29 (1.28-1.31)	3.46 (3.28-3.63)

c) For mothers aged ≥40 years

Region	Total births	40-44 years			≥45 years			Overall ≥40 years		
	(N)	Birth (%)	RR (95% CI)	PAF% (95% CI)	Birth (%)	RR (95% CI)	PAF% (95% CI)	Birth (%)	RR (95% CI)	PAF% (95% CI)
HICs	143,845,444	3.15	1.86 (1.84-1.88)	2.64 (2.58-2.71)	0.24	2.32 (2.24-2.40)	0.32 (0.30-0.33)	3.39	1.89 (1.87-1.92)	2.94 (2.88-3.01)
LMICs	38,071,936	3.22	1.90 (1.86-1.93)	2.81 (2.71-2.90)	0.22	3.12 (2.99-3.26)	0.46 (0.43-0.49)	3.44	1.97 (1.94-2.01)	3.24 (3.14-3.34)